Hely

Pattern and photos: Tiina Kuu

Hely is a mitten pattern with a modified arched thumb gusset and a round, symmetrical tip. The easy stranded colourwork pattern serves as a transition from the first colour to the second.

YARN AND YARDAGE

Tukuwool Fingering (100 % wool; 400 m / 100 g)

Main colour (MC): 30-40 grams of brown (H32 nila colourway)

Contrast colour (CC): 15-25 grams of grey (02 humu colourway)

Any fingering weight yarns can be used.

GAUGE

32 sts and 42 rows in stockinette with smaller needles = 10 cm / 4 inches

NEEDLES

At least 80 cm / 32 inch long circular needles, 2.0 mm / US½ and 2.5 mm / US1½ (or suitable to obtain gauge).

The mittens can be knitted with dpns, two shorter circulars or a mini circular but the instructions have been written for magic loop.

OTHER SUPPLIES

stitch holders, safety pins or pieces of scrap yarn for holding the thumb sts

1 stitch marker

SIZES

There are instructions for sizes small (48 sts for the wrist and 54 sts for the hand), medium (56 sts for the wrist and 60 sts for the hand) and large (60 sts for the wrist and 66 sts for the hand), which are referred to in the instructions as S (M, L). If only one stitch count is given, it applies to all sizes. With the gauge given, sizes S (M, L) snuggly fit a hand circumference of approximately 17 (19, 20.5) cm / 6⅝ (7⅜, 8⅛) inches.

BEFORE YOU START

Please read the instructions carefully. Please note that there are separate instructions for the right and left mittens. In the left mitten, the thumb gusset and palm are worked on needle 1, and the back of the hand is worked on needle 2. In the right mitten, the back of the hand is worked on needle 1, and the thumb gusset and palm are worked on needle 2.

Please note that the beginning of the round is slightly on the palm side of the mitten. The stitches are redistributed prior to the stranded colourwork and tip.

INSTRUCTIONS for the **LEFT** mitten

Cuff

With the main colour (MC) and smaller needles, CO 48 (56, 60) sts. Distribute the sts as follows: 24 (28, 28) sts onto needle 1 and 24 (28, 32) sts onto needle 2. Join to begin working in the round, being careful not to twist.

Work *k2, p2* ribbing for 26 (28, 30) rnds or to desired ribbing length.

Thumb gusset

Work a set-up rnd as follows for each size:

size S: On needle 1, k4, place marker, k8, M1R and knit to the end of the needle. On needle 2, k12, M1R and knit to the end of the needle. *There are now 25 sts on each needle.*

size M: On needle 1, k4, place marker and knit to the end of the round.

size L: On needle 1, k4, place marker, k11, M1R and knit to the end of the needle. On needle 2, k17, M1R and knit to the end of the needle. *There are now 29 sts on needle 1 and 33 sts on needle 2.*

Work the arched thumb gusset as follows:

rnd 1: Knit to the marker, M1R, sm and knit to the end of the rnd.

rnd 2: Knit, slipping the marker on the way.

Repeat rnds 1 and 2 a total of 2 (3, 4) times, i.e., a total of 4 (6, 8) rnds. Then, repeat only rnd 1 a total of 14 (15, 16) times. *There are now 41 (46, 49) sts on needle 1 and 25 (28, 33) sts on needle 2.*

INSTRUCTIONS for the **RIGHT** mitten

Cuff

With the main colour (MC) and smaller needles, CO 48 (56, 60) sts. Distribute the sts as follows: 24 (28, 32) sts onto needle 1 and 24 (28, 28) sts onto needle 2. Join to begin working in the round, being careful not to twist.

Work *p2, k2* ribbing for 26 (28, 30) rnds or to desired ribbing length.

Thumb gusset

Work a set-up rnd as follows for each size:

size S: On needle 1, k12, M1L and knit to the end of the needle. On needle 2, k12, M1L, k8, place marker and knit to the end of the needle. *There are now 25 sts on each needle.*

size M: Knit the sts on needle 1. On needle 2, k24, place marker and knit to the end of the needle.

size L: On needle 1, k15, M1L and knit to the end of the needle. On needle 2, k13, M1L, k11, place marker and knit to the end of the needle. *There are now 33 sts on needle 1 and 29 sts on needle 2.*

Work the arched thumb gusset as follows:

rnd 1: Knit to the marker, sm, M1L, and knit to the end of the rnd.

rnd 2: Knit, slipping the marker on the way.

Repeat rnds 1 and 2 a total of 2 (3, 4) times, i.e., a total of 4 (6, 8) rnds. Then, repeat only rnd 1 a total of 14 (15, 16) times. *There are now 25 (28, 33) sts on needle 1 and 41 (46, 49) sts on needle 2.*

INSTRUCTIONS for the **LEFT** mitten

Hand

Knit to the marker, rm. Slip the next 16 (18, 20) sts onto a stitch holder, safety pin or a piece of scrap yarn. With the backwards loop CO technique, CO 4 sts onto the right hand needle. Then, knit the next 3 (4, 5) sts on the left hand needle onto the right hand needle (i.e., needle 1). Slip the remaining 2 (2, 0) sts on the left hand needle onto needle 2. Knit the sts on needle 2. *There are now 27 (30, 33) sts on each needle.*

Knit 4 (6, 8) rnds or until ready to start the stranded colourwork.

Switch to larger needles if desired and attach the contrast colour (CC). Work chart A, rows 1-17. *Each chart row is repeated 9 (10, 11) times in each round.*

Cut MC and switch to smaller needles if desired. Work in stockinette stitch until work measures approximately 3 (4, 5) cm / 1⅛ (1⅝, 2) inches less than the desired final length.

Chart A

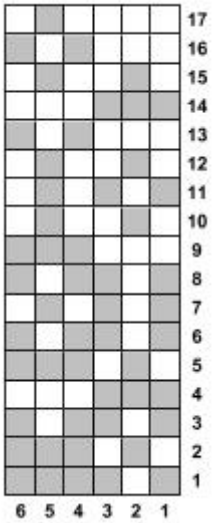

Chart key

INSTRUCTIONS for the **RIGHT** mitten

Hand

Knit the sts on needle 1. Knit the first 2 (2, 0) sts on needle 2 and slip them onto needle 1. On needle 2, k3 (k4, k5). Slip the next 16 (18, 20) sts onto a stitch holder, safety pin or a piece of scrap yarn, rm. With the backwards loop CO technique, CO 4 sts onto the right hand needle. Then, knit the remaining 20 (22 24) sts on the left hand needle onto the right hand needle (i.e., needle 2). *There are now 27 (30, 33) sts on each needle.*

Knit 4 (6, 8) rnds or until ready to start the stranded colourwork.

Switch to larger needles if desired and attach the contrast colour (CC). Work chart A, rows 1-17. *Each chart row is repeated 9 (10, 11) times in each round.*

Cut MC and switch to smaller needles if desired. Work in stockinette stitch until work measures approximately 3 (4, 5) cm / 1⅛ (1⅝, 2) inches less than the desired final length.

Sample pair with reversed colours.

INSTRUCTIONS for the **LEFT** mitten

Tip

Work the tip decreases as follows for each size:

size S

rnd 1: 6 times *ssk, k7* (48 sts)
rnds 2-4 (i.e., 3 rnds): Knit.
rnd 5: 6 times *ssk, k6* (42 sts)
rnds 6-7 (i.e, 2 rnds): Knit.
rnd 8: 6 times *ssk, k5* (36 sts)
rnd 9: Knit.
rnd 10: 6 times *ssk, k4* (30 sts)
rnd 11: 6 times *ssk, k3* (24 sts)
rnd 12: 6 times *ssk, k2* (18 sts)
rnd 13: 6 times *ssk, k1* (12 sts)

size M:

rnd 1: 6 times *ssk, k8* (54 sts)
rnds 2-5 (i.e., 4 rnds): Knit.
rnds 6-18: Work according to size S, rnds 1-13.

size L:

rnd 1: 6 times *ssk, k9* (60 sts)
rnds 2-5 (i.e., 4 rnds): Knit
rnd 6: 6 times *ssk, k8* (54 sts)
rnds 7-9 (i.e., 3 rnds): Knit.
rnds 10-22: Work according to size S, rnds 1-13.

Cut the yarn and pull through the remaining 12 sts twice. Fasten tight.

INSTRUCTIONS for the **RIGHT** mitten

Tip

Work the tip decreases as follows for each size:

size S

rnd 1: 6 times *k7, k2tog* (48 sts)
rnds 2-4 (i.e., 3 rnds): Knit.
rnd 5: 6 times *k6, k2tog* (42 sts)
rnds 6-7 (i.e, 2 rnds): Knit.
rnd 8: 6 times *k5, k2tog* (36 sts)
rnd 9: Knit.
rnd 10: 6 times *k4, k2tog* (30 sts)
rnd 11: 6 times *k3, k2tog* (24 sts)
rnd 12: 6 times *k2, k2tog* (18 sts)
rnd 13: 6 times *k1, k2tog* (12 sts)

size M:

rnd 1: 6 times *k8, k2tog* (54 sts)
rnds 2-5 (i.e., 4 rnds): Knit.
rnds 6-18: Work according to size S, rnds 1-13.

size L:

rnd 1: 6 times *k9, k2tog* (60 sts)
rnds 2-5 (i.e., 4 rnds): Knit
rnd 6: 6 times *k8, k2tog* (54 sts)
rnds 7-9 (i.e., 3 rnds): Knit.
rnds 10-22: Work according to size S, rnds 1-13.

Cut the yarn and pull through the remaining 12 sts twice. Fasten tight.

INSTRUCTIONS for **BOTH** mittens

Thumb

Using smaller needles, distribute the sts left on hold for the thumb evenly onto needle 1 and 2. Along the upper part of the thumb opening, pick up 3 sts onto each needle. *There are now 11 (12, 13) sts on each needle.*

Attach MC and work in stockinette stitch until the tip of the thumb is almost covered.

Work the thumb tip decreases for each size as follows:

size S:

rnd 1: K6, k2tog, knit to the end of the rnd. (21 sts)
rnd 2: 3 times *k5, k2tog* (18 sts)
rnd 3: 3 times *k4, k2tog* (15 sts)
rnd 4: 3 times *k3, k2tog* (12 sts)
rnd 5: 3 times *k2, k2tog* (9 sts)
rnd 6: 3 times *k1, k2tog* (6 sts)

size M:

rnd 1: 3 times *k6, k2tog* (21 sts)
rnds 2-6: Work according to size S, rnds 2-6.

size L:

rnd 1: K7, k2tog, k7, k2tog, k8 (24 sts).
rnd 2: 3 times *k6, k2tog* (21 sts)
rnds 3-7: Work according to size S, rnds 2-6.

Cut the yarn and pull through the remaining 6 sts twice. Fasten tight.

FINISHING

Soak the mittens in lukewarm water. Remove excess water by rolling the mittens inside a towel. Stretch to desired measures and let dry flat or on mitten blockers. Weave in the ends.

ABBREVIATIONS

CC – contrast colour
CO – cast on
dpns – double pointed needles
k – knit
k2tog – knit 2 sts together
MC – main colour
M1L – make 1 st leaning left
M1R – make 1 st leaning right
p – purl
rm – remove marker
rnd(s) – round(s)
sm – slip marker
ssk – slip, slip, knit
st(s) – stitch(es)

TECHNICAL TIPS

Backwards loop CO:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ojOU7Bco4dM

M1L:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pdzAsvI9_sc

M1R:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gz40VVSwL5A